

TalentFlow — User Manual

Candidate + recruiter guide for the current MVP

1. Getting started

Open the TalentFlow frontend, sign in with a valid account, and use the sidebar to move between Dashboard, Jobs, Applications and Pipeline. Recruiter and candidate experiences are role-aware.

2. Candidate workflow

Browse published jobs → open a job → review company, description and required skills → apply → view the application in Applications → track the recruiter-controlled status.

3. Recruiter workflow

Open Dashboard → create a job → choose required skills → publish/use the job → review incoming applications → open Pipeline → use the status selector to move a candidate through Applied, Screening, Shortlisted, Interview, Offer and Hired.

4. Job creation

The Create Job form captures the role information and allows multiple skills to be selected. The frontend sends `skill_ids` to the API, while the backend serializer resolves those IDs into JobSkill relationships.

5. Pipeline status management

Recruiters can change an application status directly from the Pipeline page. The browser sends a PATCH request to the application endpoint. Django validates and persists the new status, and the UI reloads the pipeline so the card appears in the new column.

6. Current MVP boundaries

Interview scheduling UI, richer notifications, advanced analytics, resume parsing, AI matching, automated test coverage and production deployment are future improvements. The README distinguishes implemented functionality from roadmap features.

7. Demo accounts

Local demo accounts used during development: **demo_recruiter** and **demo_candidate**. For a public repository, never commit real passwords or API tokens; keep secrets in `.env` and exclude them with `.gitignore`.

8. Quick troubleshooting

401/invalid token → clear the local demo token and sign in again. 400 login → verify the account password and role. Pipeline not updating → verify the PATCH request and reload. Backend errors → run **python manage.py check** and inspect the Django terminal.